

**Regular Meeting
Monday, April 1, 2019
Medford School Committee
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, and High School Representative Jasper Su.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:10PM.

Approval of Minutes of March 18, 2019 - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Motion to table offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Community Participation - Ms. DiBenedetto - I want to bring concerns to the committee under this category. Mayor Burke - We can not take action unless these items are listed on the agenda.

Motion for suspension of the rules to take items out of order offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Motion to approve anonymous donation to Ethics Bowl team offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative, 0 Negative, Motion passes. Please send thank you letter to the donor.

Motion to revert to regular schedule offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Diane Caldwell - Albert Farah, Class of 2020, has been selected as a Massachusetts delegate to the International Science and Engineering Fair. His project was Modeling Mass Flow Distribution in a multistage rocket concept design. This year, the Fair will be held in Phoenix, Arizona, from May 12-17, 2019.

On the first day of spring, over 500 students from the Andrews Middle School cleaned around the Mystic River walking path, and other areas surrounding the school.

The Medford Family Network's Major Fundraiser of the Year, Night of 10,000 Lights will be held here at City Hall this Saturday, April 6th at 7pm.

We met with parents from all elementary schools to discuss their concerns about the middle school lottery. We felt the meetings alleviated a lot of the stress parents were feeling and we hopefully addressed their concerns. An outside organization will handle the lottery.

April 2 sibling opt-in forms sent home with students.

April 9 sibling opt-in forms are due back.

April 23 each 5th grade student will receive a lottery number.

April 30 3pm-4pm lottery will take place in Medford High School library. Parents and families are welcome to attend.

May 8 6pm-8pm Andrews orientation.

May 14 6pm-8pm McGlynn orientation.

This Thursday, April 4th the Medford Vocational Technical High School will host its CTE Grade 9 Showcase, which will enable the students to discuss options for next year, meet with MVTHS administrators and make selections for courses.

Last Thursday, Family Math Nights were held at both the McGlynn and Columbus Elementary Schools.

Pathways to Mathematics Presentation has been planned for Thursday, April 11th, for 6th Grade Parents, from 6:30 – 7:30pm, in Room B 310 at Medford High School. Our Math Director, Faiza Khan, will discuss shifts in middle school mathematics education, the impact of mathematics curriculum on high school decisions, and the opportunities for middle and high school mathematics courses.

Medford Credit for Life Financial Literacy Fair will be on Friday, April 5.

Center for Citizenship and Social Responsibility Update - Rich Trotta and Michael Skorker - We want to thank the school committee for their support. We also thank Tufts University, Superintendent Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Caldwell, and Assistant Superintendent Patterson for their support. One of our students recently used the Arlington Capitol Theater to do a showing of Green Book and led a discussion of racism. Teachers can use funds from our budget to do projects inside the classroom. We hosted a Memorial Day event last year and hope to repeat it again this year. We used the Krystle Campbell Memorial Fund to stimulate students, parents, people in the community to think about the environment. Speakers, empathy, respect and passion for others. Coming up we have Dr. Chopra, a surgeon, director of surgery at Harvard Medical School, and he is going to talk about leadership. May 29, 6:30pm.

We applied to be part of the Massachusetts Association of Superintendents conference, we were accepted and will be hosting a workshop or table.

Mr. Skorker - Thank you for being so supportive of our program. This has been one of the best journeys of my career. The children are awe inspiring and make the world a better place. They always exceed my expectations. This year we have about 400 students participating district wide. We meet every month to collaborate. This is project fair season: High School project fair is April 25, 2:30-4pm at the high school. The other schools are working on their dates for their project fairs. The Mustang Way assembly was a collaboration between the high school and the middle schools. It promoted respect, kindness, and acceptance and was well received by faculty, students, and staff at both middle schools. Last Monday four of our students won a grant from the Captain Planet Foundation to become global and local changemakers, implementing composting bins and pickups in the Medford High School cafeteria. Rubia Fernanda has been working with the Mayor's office on the plastic bag ordinance and I would like to say congratulations to her. Jasper Su has been like my secretary, the book you see in front of you is a lot of his doing.

Jenny Lu and Joseph Schmidt - Medford Slavery Memorial, in collaboration with two fourth graders at the Brooks Elementary School. Our project is for a memorial for 50 enslaved people buried at the Salem Street Burial Ground who do not have grave markers. June 8th at 10:30am, all are invited. We will unveil a monument to the slaves. We raised over \$2,000 for this project and we are waiting to hear back from Freedom's Way Partnership matching grant who will match the amount we raised. Mayor Burke - I am so proud of both of you.

John Intoppa - I am the senior class president and I run the Project Little Libraries. Through CCSR I have fine tuned my social responsibility and leadership skills.

Ms. Mustone - Is the Cummings Foundation grant running out? Mr. Trotta - We are in year 2 of a 3 year grant. We are looking for more funding, it pays our stipends. I am constantly looking for other sources, publicity for the program.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Can you break this down to the basics for people at home? Mr. Trotta - It is an after school program. We do not turn any students away. Mr. Skorker - At the high school we meet twice a month. Anyone can be involved. Jasper Su - The website is www.medfordccsr.org

Motion to accept report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion carries.

Recognition of SkillsUSA Winners - Chad Fallon - Congratulations to all winners.

Recognition of DECA Winners - Chad Fallon - Congratulations to all winners.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip - DECA International Career Development Conference - Chad Fallon - We are requesting approval for the field trip to go to compete in Nationals in Florida. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Roll call vote.

6 Affirmative

1 Absent - Mr. Ruggiero

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Field Trip - SkillsUSA State Conference - Chad Fallon - We are asking for approval for an overnight trip for the SkillsUSA winners to be able to compete. Janet Esposito fundraised and they raised much more than anticipated so the cost will be much less. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

6 Affirmative

1 Absent - Mr. Ruggiero

Motion passes.

Medford Vocational Technical High School Update - Chad Fallon - We have done new hiring. Upgrades in auto technology through Perkins funding, which will bring the automotive shop to industry standard. We will host a grand opening with a ribbon cutting in the front of the building. We will open our new salon upstairs so it is more accessible to visitors. We have funding through a donor. Grade 9 CTE Student Showcase - April 4th - a great opportunity for parents to see what their children are doing. Thank you to Superintendent Edouard-Vincent for your support and enthusiasm for vocational education and to the School Committee members for their continued support. Jasper Su - When I was in 9th grade I took Metal Fab/HVAC and after that I had to decide between honors classes and continuing vocational classes. Are there plans to make it possible to do both? Mr. Fallon - We currently do not have a schedule that can fully align both schools at the Medford High School campus. Phase 1 was the merger, phase 2 needs to be a new schedule. There are growing pains with the merge. My main concern is what you are saying. How do we make sure all students have access to all programs. Mr. D'Alleva has been a great partner principal and we share a vision. We need a new schedule.

Report on Professional Development Day - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli - I have had a great mentor in Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell. Programs are important but nothing is more important than supporting our professionals and giving them the resources they need to succeed. Ms. Caldwell - I thank Dr. Ricciardelli for stepping up and taking over professional development

as I have had to take on more responsibility this year. Motion to accept report and place on file offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Motion to table Report on Superintendent's Entry Plan Findings until the Superintendent is available to present the report offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Condolences: Louise Bianchi, Donna Deranian, Richard Elliott, Robert Connelly, Marie Charite Pavelus.

Motion to move to executive session offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Roll call vote.

7 Affirmative

0 Negative

Motion passes.

Members entered executive session at 8:33pm.

Members exited executive session at 8:50pm.